

A UI Design Document (sometimes called a Design System, UI Spec, or Style Guide) usually contains these sections:

1. Overview

- Product name
- Purpose
- Target audience
- Design principles

2. Brand Identity

- Logo usage
- Brand voice
- Brand values

3. Color System

- Primary colors
- Secondary colors
- Accent colors
- Success, warning, error states
- Neutral/grayscale palette
- Accessibility contrast ratios

Example:

- Primary: #4F46E5
- Success: #22C55E
- Error: #EF4444

4. Typography

- Font families
- Font weights
- Type scale
- Line heights
- Letter spacing

Example:

Style	Size	Weight
H1	48px	Bold
H2	36px	Bold

Style	Size	Weight
Body	16px	Regular
Caption	12px	Medium

5. Spacing System

- Grid system
- Margins
- Padding
- Layout rules

Example:

- 4px base unit
 - 8px spacing
 - 16px spacing
 - 24px spacing
-

6. Components

For each component include:

- Variants
- States
- Usage guidelines

Examples:

- Buttons
 - Inputs
 - Dropdowns
 - Modals
 - Cards
 - Navigation
 - Tables
 - Tooltips
-

7. Icons & Illustrations

- Icon library

- Icon sizing
 - Illustration style
 - Usage rules
-

8. Layout Patterns

- Desktop layouts
 - Tablet layouts
 - Mobile layouts
 - Responsive behavior
-

9. Navigation

- Information architecture
 - Menu structure
 - User flows
 - Breadcrumbs
-

10. Accessibility

- WCAG compliance
 - Keyboard navigation
 - Focus states
 - Screen reader support
 - Color contrast requirements
-

11. Motion & Animation

- Transition durations
- Hover effects
- Loading states
- Microinteractions

Example:

- Fast: 150ms
 - Medium: 300ms
 - Slow: 500ms
-

12. Design Tokens

The actual variables developers use.

🔗 CSS



```
--color-primary: #4F46E5;  
--spacing-md: 16px;  
--radius-lg: 12px;  
--font-body: Inter;
```

13. Screens / Wireframes

- Home page
- Dashboard
- Settings
- Profile
- Empty states
- Error states

14. Developer Handoff

- Component specs
- Figma links
- Asset exports
- CSS/Tailwind variables
- API considerations

A typical professional UI design doc hierarchy looks like:

```
1. Overview  
2. Brand Identity  
3. Colors  
4. Typography  
5. Spacing & Grid  
6. Components  
7. Icons & Imagery  
8. Layouts  
9. Navigation  
10. Accessibility  
11. Motion  
12. Design Tokens  
13. Screen Designs  
14. Developer Handoff
```



If you're building a SaaS dashboard or app, the most important sections are usually:

Colors → Typography → Spacing → Components → Layouts → Accessibility → Developer Handoff.